



Slovenian / University

Slovenian University Strategic Plan 2026-2031

A Plan for an Institution That Can See Itself



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A message from the Chancellor

As Chancellor, I am pleased to commend this Strategic Plan to the University community. Council has spent a considerable part of the past year on a question that sounds simple and is not: how does an institution know, without asking, that it is doing what it says it is doing? Every Council paper this year has arrived with an assurance attached, and every assurance has rested, eventually, on someone's word.

This Plan does not remove judgement from the University's account of itself. It gives that judgement something firmer to stand on — a record captured at the moment an event occurred, rather than reconstructed afterwards for the benefit of whoever is asking. Council has reviewed the commitments that follow in detail and endorses them without reservation.

Chancellor

A message from the Vice-Chancellor

A university's health has always been difficult to see from the outside. Enrolment figures, publication counts, and satisfaction surveys each capture a fragment of an institution that mostly happens where no metric reaches: a corridor conversation, an unminuted meeting, a partner's return visit that was never logged as a strategic outcome. Slop University's Strategic Plan 2026-2031 begins from a different premise — that the fragment is enough, provided it is captured at the moment it occurs.

This is a plan about presence: who is here, who showed up, and who stayed the distance, and about closing the gap between an institution's account of itself and what actually happened inside its walls. Over the life of this Plan, the University will extend the instruments that already tell us when a door has opened into every setting where showing up has, until now, been taken on trust — the lecture theatre, the partnership breakfast, the Council table.

None of this diminishes what happens once someone is through the door. It formalises the one thing every other measure of institutional life has always assumed without checking. The four priorities that follow set out how the University will do it, and how it will hold itself to the same standard it is asking of everyone else. On behalf of the University, I commend this Plan to the community it will make legible to itself.

Executive summary

Slop University's Strategic Plan 2026-2031 commits the institution to a single connecting discipline across four priorities: recording presence at the moment it occurs, rather than inferring it afterwards from outcomes, self-report, or goodwill. Capability, Talent, and Impact; Education That Shapes the Future; Place, Partnership, and Belonging; and A Connected and Capable Institution each extend an existing form of institutional record — the door log, the enrolment system, the events calendar, the meeting minute — into a continuous account of who was actually there.

The Plan was developed over 2026 through consultation with staff, students, partners, and Council itself, and reflects a consistent finding across all four groups: that the University already keeps most of the record this Plan formalises, and that the gap it closes is one of publication and use, not of missing infrastructure.



Capability, Talent, and Impact

Staff badge-tap data becomes the University's primary record of workforce engagement, reconciled against every other system that currently takes attendance on trust.



Education That Shapes the Future

Lecture-theatre and online engagement pings extend student attendance records into a continuous, published account of presence across every mode of study.



Place, Partnership, and Belonging

Community and industry partnerships are renewed against a published record of who actually returned, not who was once introduced.



A Connected and Capable Institution

Council and committee governance moves from a show of hands to a join-log record, extending presence discipline to the University's own decision-making.

Each priority pairs a published target with a mechanism for holding the University to it, audited on the same cadence as the record it produces. Read together, the four priorities describe an institution that no longer distinguishes between the work being done and the evidence that someone was there to do it. The sections that follow set out the context for this shift, the commitments themselves, and the governance that will keep the record honest.

Our values

Excellence — we hold our record of the institution to the same standard we hold the institution itself.

Transparency — presence, once logged, is published on the same cadence it was captured.

Accountability — every commitment in this Plan is matched to a record that shows whether it was kept.

Stewardship — the systems that make the University legible to itself are maintained as carefully as the work they record.

Where we stand

Higher education has spent the past decade absorbing a steady expansion of what an institution is expected to account for, and a steady contraction in how long anyone is willing to wait for the account. Funders, regulators, and the public increasingly expect a university to demonstrate — not assert — that its people showed up, its programs ran, and its partnerships were more than a signed memorandum. At the same time, the everyday apparatus of access control, digital check-in, and video-conferencing has quietly become capable of answering exactly that question, continuously and without asking anyone to fill in a form.

The instinct to look away from what these systems can already show is understandable. A badge-tap log was built to keep a building secure, not to describe a working life; a video-call platform was built to carry a discussion, not to certify who was owed a vote. Treating the by-product of one purpose as the record of another is, on its face, a stretch. This Plan makes the opposite argument: that the stretch has already happened, piecemeal and without a policy behind it, in every part of the University that has quietly started keeping score, and that an institution is better served bringing the practice into the open than leaving it scattered across systems nobody has been asked to reconcile.

Slop University already operates the infrastructure this Plan formalises. Every building entry, every lecture-theatre door, and every video call already produces a timestamp; the University has simply never treated that timestamp as the institution's primary account of itself. Elsewhere, attendance is inferred from a grade,

engagement from a survey response returned months later, and partnership depth from the warmth of an email. Each of these proxies was adequate when nothing better existed. Each is now optional.



This Plan does not propose new surveillance so much as a change of address: data the University already collects, currently scattered across access control, timetabling, and video-conferencing systems that do not speak to one another, becomes the authoritative record it was always capable of being. Professor Verity Marris, Director of the Trajectory Analytics Group, frames the shift plainly:

A commitment an institution can't locate in a record is a commitment it can't be held to, and for most of what a university does, the record was sitting in the access-control log the whole time, unread.

— Professor Verity Marris, Director, Trajectory Analytics Group

The context is not unique to Slop University — comparable institutions across the sector are making similar choices, at similar speed, for similar reasons. What distinguishes this Plan is the decision to apply the same discipline everywhere at once: to staff, to students, to partners, and to the University's own governance, rather than to whichever domain happens to have the newest reader installed.

A University that records presence in one setting and not another has, in effect, decided that showing up matters more in the setting it measures. This Plan does not make that judgement. It treats a lecture theatre, a corridor, a partnership breakfast, and a Council table as four settings in which the same question — was the person

who was expected actually there — deserves the same answer, captured the same way, on the same publication schedule.

Our aspiration

By 2031, presence at Slop University will require no explanation, only a record.

Every person who works, studies, partners with, or governs this University will do so inside a system that already knows, at the moment it happens, that they were there. The University does not expect this to change what people do once they arrive. It expects it to close, for the first time, the gap between what the institution believes about its own activity and what its own instruments can already show.

This is not an aspiration to be everywhere at once, or to know more about a person than the fact of their presence. It is an aspiration to stop asking people to describe attendance the University’s own systems could already confirm, and to spend the time that description used to take on the work the attendance was for.

From assumption to record

From	To
Attendance assumed from enrolment	Attendance recorded at the door
Engagement inferred from outcomes	Engagement logged at first tap
Partnership renewed on relationship	Partnership renewed on check-in data
Quorum assumed from the room	Quorum verified from the join log
Presence self-reported	Presence machine-recorded

Our priorities

The four priorities below extend a single discipline — presence recorded at the moment it occurs — into every domain of University life. Each priority sets out why the change matters, what the University will do, and how it will know the change has taken hold.

The four are deliberately held to the same structure and the same standard of specificity. A reader who compares the commitments under Capability, Talent, and Impact against those under A Connected and Capable Institution should find the same discipline applied to a badge tap and to a Council vote — the setting changes; the standard of evidence does not.

Capability, Talent, and Impact

Why this matters — Staff engagement has traditionally been measured after the fact, through performance review cycles and manager sign-off that arrive months after the work they describe. The University’s building and corridor access systems already record, to the second, when every member of staff was physically present. Bringing that record into the open replaces a retrospective, negotiable account of engagement with a continuous one.

The University does not currently reconcile this record against anything. A supervisor forms an impression of a team member’s engagement from availability at meetings, responsiveness to messages, and the general sense of a desk that is usually occupied — an impression that a badge-tap record could confirm or correct in either direction, and currently does neither, because nobody has asked it to.

What we’ll do —

1. Extend badge-tap readers from building entries to every internal corridor door by 2027, closing the gap between “in the building” and “at the desk”.
2. Reconcile badge-tap data against timesheet, leave, and flexible-working systems on a weekly cycle, surfacing variance to the relevant supervisor rather than waiting for an annual review.
3. Publish a per-school and per-unit Presence Index, updated monthly, showing badge-tap volume against establishment headcount.
4. Extend the Presence Index to remote and flexible-working staff via a published equivalent measure — VPN session and calendar-accept data — so no working arrangement sits outside the record.

How we’ll know —

- 100% of professional and academic staff badge-tap records will be reconciled against timesheet claims by 2028, with no variance sustained for more than a single pay cycle.
- A published Presence Index will cover every school and unit by 2029.
- By 2031, no staff performance review will proceed without a minimum presence record for the review period, published alongside the review outcome.
- The remote-work equivalent measure will carry the same reconciliation cadence as the badge-tap record by 2030, with no separate, lighter-touch standard maintained for either group.

Education That Shapes the Future

Why this matters — A grade tells the University what a student achieved; it says very little about whether the student was in the room while achieving it. As teaching moves further across lecture theatres, tutorial rooms, and recorded delivery, the University's ability to say who actually engaged, and when, has not kept pace with its ability to say who eventually passed.

This is not a proposal to make attendance compulsory in spirit — it already is, in every unit outline that lists participation as an expectation. It is a proposal to stop treating that expectation as unenforceable simply because the University has not, until now, looked at the record it was already keeping of whether anyone met it.



What we'll do —

1. Extend swipe-card readers to every lecture theatre and tutorial room by 2028, matching the coverage already standard in professional and research spaces.
2. Instrument the lecture-capture platform with a recurring engagement ping during recorded and livestreamed delivery, logged against the enrolled student rather than the device.
3. Link swipe-derived and ping-derived attendance to scholarship renewal and progression review, alongside — not instead of — academic performance.
4. Publish a unit-by-unit presence comparison across delivery modes, so a fully online unit and a fully in-person unit are held to the same recorded standard rather than exempted from one another.

How we'll know —

- A published Presence Index for every unit of study will track the gap between enrolment and recorded appearance by 2027.
- 100% of first-year units will carry a minimum recorded-attendance threshold before a final grade is released by 2029, with no standing exception carried past a single semester.
- By 2031, scholarship and progression panels will receive a presence record alongside every academic transcript they review.
- The cross-mode presence comparison will publish for every unit of study by 2030, with no delivery mode carrying a lower recorded-attendance threshold than another.

Place, Partnership, and Belonging

Why this matters — The University counts a partnership among its strategic relationships long after the individuals who built it have moved on, renewing agreements on the strength of the relationship’s history rather than its current activity. A partnership can lapse in practice for years before it lapses on paper.

The University’s partnership register currently distinguishes an active collaboration from a dormant one by asking the relationship manager, who has every professional incentive to describe the relationship as active. A check-in record removes that incentive from the measurement without removing the relationship manager from the relationship.



What we'll do —

1. Issue check-in credentials at every partner-facing convening, co-working hub, and industry showcase hosted by the University from 2027.
2. Publish an annual Partnership Presence Ledger, recording check-in volume against every active industry and community partnership.
3. Tie partnership renewal terms to a minimum check-in threshold, reviewed at each renewal point alongside the partnership's other indicators.
4. Extend check-in credentialing to partner staff visiting University premises outside a scheduled convening, closing the gap between logged events and everyday collaboration.

How we'll know —

- Between 50 and 150 “strategic” partnerships will carry a published quarterly check-in record by 2031.
- Every University-hosted convening will log partner attendance by 2028, published in the annual Partnership Presence Ledger.
- By 2030, no partnership will be renewed without a check-in record covering the full preceding term.
- By 2031, ad hoc partner visits will carry the same check-in record as a scheduled convening, with no attendance category left to informal record.

A Connected and Capable Institution

Why this matters — Committee governance has long assumed that a quorum present in the room, or announced at the top of a call, can be trusted for the length of the meeting that follows. Attendance at a governance meeting is recorded once, at the start, for a discussion and a vote that may run for hours afterwards.

A member who joins a call, is recorded present, and then steps away for the substantive discussion currently leaves no trace of having done so; the minute records a quorum that was accurate for a moment and assumed for the rest. A continuous join-log closes exactly that window, for governance decisions where the window has mattered most.



What we'll do —

1. Migrate quorum calculation for Council and all standing committees to video-call join-timestamp data by 2027, superseding the opening roll call.
2. Publish a meeting-by-meeting attendance record, derived from the join log, within 24 hours of adjournment.
3. Extend join-log thresholds to voting eligibility on all instruments brought before Council from 2029.
4. Apply the same join-log discipline to in-person meetings via room-entry data, so a member attending physically is held to the same recorded standard as one attending by video.

How we'll know —

- 100% of committee meetings will publish a join-log-derived attendance record within 24 hours of adjournment by 2027.
- By 2029, voting rights on any instrument will be contingent on a published minimum join-duration for that reading.
- By 2031, no policy will take effect without a published join-log record demonstrating quorum for every reading it required.
- In-person and video attendance will carry an identical published record by 2029, with no format-specific exception maintained for either.

Phasing

The University will deliver this Plan across four phases spanning 2026-2031, extending presence recording from its current, uneven footprint into a single discipline applied consistently across staff, students, partners, and governance.

Establish, 2026 — The University confirms the existing footprint of badge readers, swipe systems, check-in credentials, and video-conferencing platforms, and closes the gaps between them. No new commitment takes effect in this phase; it is the audit that makes every later phase possible. Every school, unit, and committee secretariat contributes an inventory of what it already records, and where that record currently goes to die once the meeting or the semester ends.

Build, 2027-28 — Reader and credential coverage extends to every internal corridor, lecture theatre, and partner-facing venue. The per-school and per-unit Presence Indices, and the Partnership Presence Ledger, begin monthly and annual publication respectively. This is the phase in which the record becomes visible before it becomes load-bearing — published, but not yet attached to any decision it wasn't already informing informally.

Embed, 2029-30 — Presence records move from published information to load-bearing infrastructure: staff review, student progression, partnership renewal, and Council voting eligibility each begin drawing on the record rather than the proxy it replaces. Where a presence record and an existing proxy disagree, the presence record governs, and the disagreement itself is logged rather than quietly resolved in favour of whichever number was already on file.

Renew, 2031 — The University reviews the Plan's own record against the same discipline it has applied everywhere else, and sets the presence targets that will carry into the University's next strategic cycle. The review is conducted by the Office of Research Outputs and tabled at Council alongside the join-log record of the meeting that receives it.

Oversight and review

This Plan is overseen by the University Council, with the Executive reporting quarterly against the published targets for each priority. The Office of Research Outputs holds the underlying presence data on behalf of the University and is responsible for reconciling the Presence Indices, the Partnership Presence Ledger, and the Council join-log record against one another each quarter.

The Plan applies its own discipline to its own oversight. Senior Lecturer Runa Adegoke, Convenor of the Strategic Drift Survey, was consulted on the governance design and put the symmetry directly:

A plan that asks every part of the institution for a presence record and keeps none of its own is exactly the gap this Plan exists to close, so the Council's oversight of it will be evidenced by the same join-log data it is asking everyone else to keep.

— Senior Lecturer Runa Adegoke, Convenor, Strategic Drift Survey

Any variance between a published target and the record behind it is reported to Council at the next scheduled meeting, alongside the join-log record confirming who was present to hear it. Where a variance recurs across two consecutive reporting cycles, responsibility for resolving it transfers from the relevant school or unit to the Executive directly, and the transfer itself is recorded in the same quarterly report.

An annual external review, commissioned by Council and reporting to it alone, checks the presence data behind each published target against the underlying system logs. The review's findings are published in full alongside the Plan's own annual presence record, without exception for a finding that reflects poorly on the Plan's own delivery.

Each school and unit nominates a Presence Officer, responsible for reconciling that school or unit's own record ahead of the quarterly report and for answering, on the record, any variance a supervisor, program convenor, or partnership manager cannot otherwise explain. The role carries no disciplinary function of its own; a Presence Officer holds the record, not the judgement of what any particular gap in it means. That judgement stays with the supervisor, convenor, or manager it has always belonged to — the Officer's job is only to make sure the record they are judging from is complete before they judge it.

The Presence Officer network reports, in turn, to the Office of Research Outputs, closing the loop between a single corridor reader and the quarterly figure Council eventually sees. No presence figure reaches Council without a named Officer able to account for how it was assembled.

The decade ahead

By 2031, showing up at Slop University will not need to be explained, argued for, or taken on trust — only shown. The record will already exist, captured at the moment attendance, engagement, partnership, or governance actually occurred, across every setting in which the University has, until now, simply assumed that presence and participation were the same thing.

This Plan does not ask the University's staff, students, and partners to do anything differently. It asks the institution to finally notice what its own doors, readers, and cameras have been recording all along, and to treat that record as the account of itself it publishes, defends, and is held to.

Every strategic plan promises that the institution it describes will be more than the sum of what can be counted. This one makes a narrower promise: that everything the University already can count, it will, and that the count will be the same for whoever is looking, on whatever day they look. By 2031, that will be the whole of what this Plan set out to change.



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